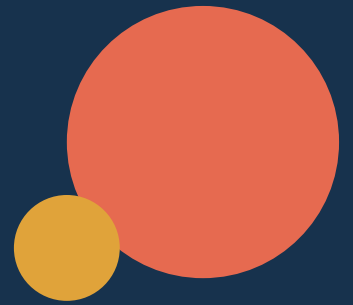


COUPLE TRIP FROM AHMEDABAD

Taiwan in November

13 nights | 14 calendar dates | 1-14 November 2026

Depart Ahmedabad 31 October | Return home 15 November



TRAVEL STYLE	Active first trip with two lighter days
ROUTE	Taipei - Taichung - Sun Moon Lake - Alishan - Tainan - Kaohsiung - Taipei
TOUR APPROACH	Value first: coach, minivan or private car are all acceptable
MAJOR DECISION	Keep Taiwan-only; save Ishigaki and Okinawa for a dedicated trip

Planning verdict: the trip length is justified, but not every pin is a must-see. Build around Taipei, the two northern excursions, Alishan and Tainan. Treat Sun Moon Lake and the second Kaohsiung day as the main optional pieces.

HOW TO USE THIS PDF

- Pages 2-5: route overview, dated itinerary and the Sun Moon Lake alternative.
- Pages 6-7: keep, shorten or skip decisions for every proposed stop.
- Pages 8-10: tour selection, booking count, deadlines, visa and transport windows.
- Pages 11-13: weather, packing, Ishigaki decision and live source links.

01 | ROUTE DESIGN

The trip at a glance

This is a 13-night trip spread across 14 dates in Taiwan. Arrival and departure reduce it to about 12 usable sightseeing days. The route is broader and less rushed than the common 8-10 day template.

BASE	NIGHTS	PURPOSE
Taipei	5 + 1	Arrival recovery, city, two northern day tours and final flight buffer
Taichung	1	Rainbow Village, National Taichung Theater and onward positioning
Sun Moon Lake	1	Scenic lighter day; the first destination to remove if simplifying
Alishan	1	Mountain forest, railway, trails and possible sunrise
Tainan	2	Best southern base for history, food and lanes
Kaohsiung	2	Harbour, art and Cijin; second day is optional

Why many online plans stop at 8-10 days

THIS PLAN	COMMON 8-10 DAY PLAN
Two separate northern excursions	Usually only Jiufen and Shifen
Taichung receives its own day	Often skipped or treated as transit
Both Sun Moon Lake and Alishan	Usually chooses one
Two nights each in Tainan and Kaohsiung	Two or three nights for the entire south
Arrival recovery and final buffer	Sightseeing starts immediately; little contingency

Nothing requires fourteen full sightseeing days. The extra time buys depth, lower fatigue and weather flexibility. Two-week itineraries do exist; they commonly add Kenting, Qingjing or the east coast. This plan uses those days for greater depth instead of adding places merely to fill time.

Days 1-5: Taipei and northern Taiwan

SAT 31 OCT SLEEP Flight PACE Travel	International departure Fly Ahmedabad to Taipei with one connection. Choose an itinerary that arrives on 1 November and returns you to Ahmedabad by Sunday, 15 November.
SUN 1 NOV SLEEP Taipei PACE Light	Arrive in Taipei Airport MRT, hotel check-in and a deliberately easy evening. If energy permits, walk Dihua Street and eat at Ningxia Night Market. Do not reserve a timed attraction for this day.
MON 2 NOV SLEEP Taipei PACE Moderate	Old Taipei and first city orientation Combine Longshan Temple, Bopiliao Historic Block and Chiang Kai-shek Memorial Hall. Continue to Yongkang Street for food. Choose Elephant Mountain near sunset only if visibility and energy are good.
TUE 3 NOV SLEEP Taipei PACE Active	Yangmingshan and Beitou geothermal day Use a shared or small-group tour. Prioritise Qingtiangang, Xiaoyoukeng fumaroles, volcanic landscapes and Beitou Thermal Valley. Shilin Night Market is optional afterwards and can be skipped if tired.
WED 4 NOV SLEEP Taipei PACE Active	Northeast coast group tour Choose the best-value coach, minivan or private-car product covering Yehliu, Jiufen, Shifen Waterfall and Shifen Old Street. Golden Waterfall and Yin-Yang Sea are useful quick additions. The lantern release is optional.
THU 5 NOV SLEEP Taipei PACE Moderate	National Palace Museum and modern Taipei Allow 2-3 hours for the museum. Continue to Songshan Cultural and Creative Park or Xinyi. Buy a Taipei 101 observatory ticket only if the sky is clear; otherwise the free Elephant Mountain skyline is better value.

Days 6-9: Taichung and the central mountains

Weather rule: keep 3-5 November interchangeable where tour availability and cancellation rules allow. Use the wettest day for the National Palace Museum.

FRI 6 NOV SLEEP Taichung PACE Moderate	Taipei to Taichung Take HSR south. Visit Rainbow Village for only 30-45 minutes, then spend meaningful time at the National Taichung Theater. Add Calligraphy Greenway or Fengjia Night Market only if they suit your energy.
SAT 7 NOV SLEEP Sun Moon Lake PACE Light	Taichung to Sun Moon Lake Travel to Shuishe. Cycle a scenic lakeside section, visit Wenwu Temple and take a boat to Ita Thao if conditions are pleasant. Stay near Shuishe for the limited onward connection. This is the itinerary's most optional overnight.
SUN 8 NOV SLEEP Alishan PACE Travel + walk	Sun Moon Lake to Alishan Use the limited direct Yuanlin Bus or a prearranged shared transfer. The published bus journey is 08:00-13:00. After arrival, walk the forest trails and giant-tree boardwalks, then seek sunset if weather permits. This is Diwali and also the plan's least elegant travel day.
MON 9 NOV SLEEP Tainan PACE Active	Alishan sunrise, forest and descent Try the Zhushan sunrise train if the forecast is reasonable, but treat the forest as the dependable highlight. Complete the Sisters Ponds and giant-tree area, descend through Chiayi and continue to Tainan. Keep the Tainan evening easy.

Preferred alternative if Sun Moon Lake is removed

6 Nov: Taichung as planned. 7 Nov: travel through Chiayi to Alishan. 8 Nov: full, comparatively relaxed Alishan day. 9 Nov: descend to Tainan. This removes one hotel change, provides a weather buffer and makes Diwali more relaxed.

Why Alishan remains a core stop

The sunrise is weather-dependent; the forest railway, cool mountain environment, giant trees and trails are the real reasons to go. Pack enough warmth for the pre-dawn outing and rain-resistant shoes for misty paths.

Days 10-14: Tainan, Kaohsiung and return

TUE 10 NOV SLEEP Tainan PACE Active	Tainan: history, lanes and food Build the day around the Confucius Temple district, central lanes and Chihkan area, then visit Anping Fort and Anping Tree House. Hayashi Department Store is optional. Leave time to eat rather than racing between monuments.
WED 11 NOV SLEEP Kaohsiung PACE Moderate	Tainan to Kaohsiung Enjoy a slow Tainan breakfast, then take the short train south. Explore Pier-2 Art Center and the old harbour before taking the ferry to Cijin for late afternoon and sunset.
THU 12 NOV SLEEP Kaohsiung PACE Moderate	Kaohsiung choice day Choose one interest-led direction: Fo Guang Shan Buddha Museum for monumental Buddhist art, or Lotus Pond plus Weiwuying for urban architecture. Do not do all of them merely because they appear on lists. This is the second easiest full day to remove after Sun Moon Lake.
FRI 13 NOV SLEEP Taipei PACE Light	Return to Taipei Take HSR from Zuoying to Taipei. Use the afternoon for shopping, cafes, a massage or anything missed earlier. More importantly, this protects the international flight from mountain or railway disruption.
SAT 14 NOV SLEEP Flight PACE Travel	Fly home Travel from Taipei to Taoyuan Airport and fly to Ahmedabad. Select a routing that arrives no later than Sunday, 15 November.

Suggested hotel areas

Taipei Main Station or Zhongshan	Taichung West District or taxi-friendly
Sun Moon Lake Shuishe for the Alishan bus	Alishan Inside/beside the recreation area
Tainan West Central District	Kaohsiung Yancheng/Pier-2 or Formosa Blvd

03 | RECOMMENDATION AUDIT

What to keep, shorten or skip

The itinerary is a route plus a menu. These verdicts prevent famous places from consuming time merely because they are famous.

PLACE	VERDICT	WHY / HOW TO USE IT
Taipei old districts	KEEP	Longshan, Bopiliao and nearby streets form one compact historical half-day. Add CKS Memorial Hall for context, but limit it to about 45 minutes.
National Palace Museum	KEEP	Taiwan's strongest major museum. Two to three hours is sufficient for most first-time visitors.
Yangmingshan + Beitou	KEEP	Directly matches the geothermal interest. Fumaroles, volcanic terrain and hot-spring history complement each other.
Yehliu + Jiufen	KEEP	Yehliu is geologically unusual; Jiufen is worthwhile for the hillside setting and mining history, not an unproven Spirited Away origin story.
Shifen Waterfall	BRIEF	Worth seeing because the tour already passes it. About 45-50 minutes.
Shifen Old Street	OPTIONAL	Pleasant for a short stop. The sky-lantern activity is commercial and entirely optional.
Golden Waterfall area	BRIEF	A useful roadside addition when included, but not a reason to select a tour by itself.
Taipei 101 deck	OPTIONAL	Only pay when visibility is clear. Elephant Mountain offers the skyline with Taipei 101 in the view.

Avoid checklist tourism in Taipei

- Choose approximately two night markets. Raohe and Ningxia are the strongest pair for this route.
- Shilin, Songshan Cultural Park and additional shopping districts are flexible, not compulsory.
- If the weather is poor, move the National Palace Museum to that day where cancellation terms permit.

Central and southern Taiwan verdicts

PLACE	VERDICT	WHY / HOW TO USE IT
National Taichung Theater	KEEP	The city's strongest fit for the requested architecture. Allow time for the building rather than treating it as a photo stop.
Rainbow Village	BRIEF	Keep because it was specifically requested, but it is small. Limit to 30-45 minutes and combine it with the theater.
Calligraphy Greenway	OPTIONAL	A pleasant connector for cafes and city atmosphere. Skip if the Taichung day is already full.
Fengjia Night Market	OPTIONAL	Convenient in Taichung but not essential after visiting Taipei night markets.
Sun Moon Lake	OPTIONAL	Scenic and useful as a light day, but touristy and responsible for the awkward 8 November transfer.
Alishan	KEEP	One of the trip's defining nature stops. The forest matters more than a guaranteed sunrise.
Tainan - two nights	KEEP	The best southern destination for history, food and street texture. Do not compress it into a few hours.
Pier-2 + Cijin	KEEP	A worthwhile urban and coastal contrast that justifies at least one Kaohsiung night.
Second Kaohsiung day	OPTIONAL	Keep only for a real interest in Fo Guang Shan or modern cultural architecture. Otherwise reallocate it to Alishan or Tainan.
Final Taipei night	KEEP	This is operational risk control before the international flight, not itinerary padding.

Recommended core if the trip is shortened: Taipei + Yangmingshan/Beitou + Yehliu/Jiufen + one Taichung day + Alishan + two Tainan nights + one Kaohsiung night + the final Taipei buffer.

What to cut first

ORDER	CUT	EFFECT
1	Sun Moon Lake	One fewer hotel change; add a second Alishan night
2	Second Kaohsiung day	Retain Pier-2 and Cijin but drop the optional outer-city excursion
3	Paid Taipei 101 deck	Use Elephant Mountain or a rooftop view instead
4	Extra night markets and photo stops	No meaningful loss to the route

04 | DAY TOURS

Choose value and route, not vehicle type

A large coach, minivan or private car is acceptable. For two travellers, shared departures usually provide the best value unless custom timing changes the experience materially.

Northeast coast: required route

PRIORITY	STOP	GUIDANCE
1	Jiufen	Require about two hours. Visit for the hillside mining-town atmosphere, tea and views.
2	Yehliu	Require 60-75 minutes. Explore beyond the Queen's Head photo queue.
3	Shifen Waterfall	Include if the route passes through Shifen.
4	Golden Waterfall cluster	Good quick addition: Golden Waterfall, Yin-Yang Sea and the Thirteen Levels remains.
5	Shifen Old Street	Brief stop; lantern optional.

Current online front-runners

KKday Plan C: currently publishes Yehliu, the Golden Waterfall cluster, Jiufen, Shifen Waterfall and Shifen Old Street in one shared day, with no compulsory shopping. [Open KKday listing](#)

Klook Northeast Coast: a comparable shared/private product with the same core stops and a very large review history. [Open Klook listing](#)

Yangmingshan and Beitou: choose a shared/small-group departure covering Qingtiangang, Xiaoyoukeng and Beitou Thermal Valley. [Open Klook listing](#)

Booking checklist for either platform

CHECK	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE
Route	All core stops included; avoid long shopping or low-value photo stops
Language	Guaranteed English departure, not a last-minute language substitution
Time	At least two hours in Jiufen and 60 minutes in Yehliu
Price	Compare final total including attraction tickets, pickup and platform fees
Cancellation	Prefer free cancellation so the museum day can absorb poor weather
Private tours	Confirm whether the person is a guide or only a driver if paying a premium

05 | RESERVATIONS

What must be booked in 1.5 months

The timeline is workable. Visa or travel authorization, international flights and Alishan lodging are the only immediate pressure points.

ITEM	COUNT	WHEN	PRIORITY
International return itinerary	1	Now	Critical
Hotel stays	7	Now; refundable	Critical
Taipei day tours	2	Within 1-2 weeks	High
SML-Alishan transfer	1	After route decision	High if retained
HSR journeys	2	29-day window	Recommended
Zhushan sunrise train	1	Previous day	Optional

Working total: approximately 14 reservation actions, plus one Taiwan visa or Travel Authorization Certificate application for each traveller. Removing Sun Moon Lake reduces the hotel count from seven to six and removes its transfer booking.

Book now: 14-20 September

- Check passport validity and determine the Taiwan entry route for each traveller.
- Price and book the Ahmedabad-Taipei return flights, using changeable terms where practical.
- Decide whether Sun Moon Lake remains, because it changes the Alishan arrival plan.
- Secure a refundable Alishan room first, then all other hotels.

Book next: by late September

- Reserve the two Taipei tours with free cancellation.
- If retaining Sun Moon Lake, secure or reconfirm the limited direct Alishan transfer.
- Purchase travel insurance after the material bookings are confirmed.

Book when railway windows open

TARGET	BOOKING RULE / PLANNING DATE
HSR Taipei-Taichung, 6 Nov	HSR opens 29 days ahead; begin checking around 9 October
HSR Zuoying-Taipei, 13 Nov	Begin checking around 16 October
Chiayi-Alishan main-line train	Only for the no-Sun-Moon-Lake route; normally opens about 14 days ahead and payment is immediate
Zhushan sunrise train	Buy online by noon the preceding day or at Alishan-area counters that afternoon

05 | RESERVATIONS

Taiwan visa path and what can wait

Entry permission for Indian passport holders

First check whether each traveller qualifies for Taiwan's online Travel Authorization Certificate. Eligibility requires a regular passport, onward or return travel and a qualifying visa or residence document from one of the specified countries. Each person must qualify independently.

If either traveller is not eligible, begin the standard visitor-visa process immediately. The official tourism checklist includes the signed application form, two photographs, passport with at least six months validity, financial evidence, itinerary and return ticket. Use refundable hotel reservations where possible while the application is pending.

Do not assume that an independent Indian tourist can use the general eVisa. The currently published tourism eVisa path for Indian nationals is tied to eligible organised group tours through designated agencies.

No advance reservation normally required

TRANSPORT	ATTRACTIONS AND DAILY LIFE
Airport MRT and EasyCard	Longshan Temple and CKS Memorial Hall grounds
Taipei Metro and city buses	Rainbow Village and public areas of the Taichung Theater
Ordinary local train: Tainan-Kaohsiung	Pier-2, Cijin ferry and night markets
Most urban taxis and local buses	Most Tainan historic attractions
Sun Moon Lake boats and bike hire	National Palace general entry and Taipei 101 on a clear day

Six-week checklist

BY DATE	DONE WHEN...
20 Sep	Visa route checked; flights and refundable Alishan room secured; Sun Moon Lake decision made
27 Sep	All hotels, both Taipei tours and central-mountain transfer arranged
Mid-Oct	HSR tickets purchased as their 29-day windows open
Late Oct	Forest Railway booked if using the Chiayi-Alishan train; insurance, eSIM and airport plan complete
48 hours before	Weather checked; tours and Alishan operations reconfirmed; offline copies of documents saved

06 | PRACTICAL NOTES

November weather and packing

November is autumn in Taiwan: comfortable for walking, but conditions vary substantially between humid northern cities, warmer southern Taiwan and high-altitude Alishan.

ZONE	WHAT IT FEELS LIKE	WHAT TO WEAR
Taipei + north coast	Mild, humid and sometimes rainy or windy	T-shirt or light shirt, trousers, thin sweater and rain shell
Taichung + Tainan	Often warm in the daytime; pleasant evenings	Light summer clothing plus one layer after sunset
Kaohsiung	Usually the warmest part of the route	Breathable summer clothing, sun protection
Alishan	Cool mountain climate; much colder before sunrise	Long trousers, sweater/fleece, packable insulated jacket and rain protection

Why summer clothes and a sweater both make sense

You will generate heat while walking in cities, and southern Taiwan can still feel warm in November. A T-shirt or light shirt is comfortable during those periods. Taipei evenings, rain, air-conditioned trains and especially Alishan dawn can feel much cooler. Layers solve both conditions without requiring a heavy lowland winter wardrobe.

Compact packing list

CITY LAYERS	MOUNTAIN / WEATHER	TRIP ADMIN
4-6 breathable tops 2-3 trousers/skirts Thin sweater or cardigan Comfortable walking shoes	Packable warm jacket Compact rain shell/umbrella Non-slip shoes Small daypack and refillable bottle	Passport + printed visa/TAC Insurance details Offline reservations Power adapter and power bank

Light-day placement

- 1 November: protected arrival evening.
- 7 November: Sun Moon Lake is the planned light day if retained.
- 13 November: final Taipei buffer and recovery afternoon.
- If Sun Moon Lake is removed, 8 November becomes the relaxed full Alishan day.

07 | SCOPE DECISIONS

Why Ishigaki and Okinawa were removed

Ishigaki is worthwhile for Kabira Bay, coral, diving and snorkeling, stargazing, and excursions to Taketomi or Iriomote. Those strengths require a dedicated marine and island-focused visit rather than a rushed add-on.

FACTOR	ASSESSMENT FOR THIS TRIP
Best experiences	Marine activities and nearby islands; ideally three or four days
November	Pleasant but outside the strongest summer-to-mid-October manta period; wind and cloud are possible
Ferry	New Keelung-Ishigaki service has a limited schedule and weather disruption risk
Okinawa main island	No ferry connects Ishigaki with Naha; an additional flight would be required
Indian passport	Japan's eVisa sea-entry rule currently does not cover the Keelung-Ishigaki route
Taiwan trade-off	A workable ferry block would displace Taichung, Sun Moon Lake and Alishan

Decision: keep the November 2026 trip Taiwan-only. Consider Ishigaki later as a dedicated Yaeyama trip, ideally when snorkeling, diving and island-hopping are the primary goals.

Final planning position

- Keep the 13-night window if the budget permits; the pace is varied rather than padded.
- Decide Sun Moon Lake first because it changes hotel and Alishan transport bookings.
- If making one additional cut, remove the second Kaohsiung day, not Tainan or Alishan.
- Book visa path, flights and Alishan lodging now; the remainder is manageable within 1.5 months.

08 | SOURCES

Official links and live booking pages

Schedules, prices, opening hours and visa rules can change. Recheck these links before non-refundable payment.

1. [Taiwan Tourism Administration - climate and seasons](https://eng.taiwan.net.tw/m1.aspx?sno=0002004)
<https://eng.taiwan.net.tw/m1.aspx?sno=0002004>
2. [National Palace Museum - current opening hours](https://www.npm.gov.tw/Articles.aspx?l=2&sno;=03001437)
<https://www.npm.gov.tw/Articles.aspx?l=2&sno;=03001437>
3. [Taichung Tourism - Rainbow Village](https://travel.taichung.gov.tw/en/attractions/intro/881)
<https://travel.taichung.gov.tw/en/attractions/intro/881>
4. [National Taichung Theater - architecture](https://www.npac-ntt.org/en/about/architecture/design)
<https://www.npac-ntt.org/en/about/architecture/design>
5. [Alishan Scenic Area - transport and Sun Moon Lake bus](https://www.ali-nsa.net/en/traffic/transport)
<https://www.ali-nsa.net/en/traffic/transport>
6. [Alishan Scenic Area - weather and packing FAQ](https://www.ali-nsa.net/en/faqs)
<https://www.ali-nsa.net/en/faqs>
7. [Alishan Forest Railway - official site](https://afrch.forest.gov.tw/EN)
<https://afrch.forest.gov.tw/EN>
8. [Alishan Forest Railway - ticket guidance](https://afrch.forest.gov.tw/EN/0000183)
<https://afrch.forest.gov.tw/EN/0000183>
9. [Taiwan High Speed Rail - online booking and 29-day window](https://en.thsrc.com.tw/ArticleContent/906de59a-8ea0-425a-8055-ca3afded9a3e)
<https://en.thsrc.com.tw/ArticleContent/906de59a-8ea0-425a-8055-ca3afded9a3e>
10. [Taiwan BOCA - Travel Authorization Certificate](https://www.boca.gov.tw/fp-152-274-8c0e2-2.html)
<https://www.boca.gov.tw/fp-152-274-8c0e2-2.html>
11. [Taiwan BOCA - visitor visa for tourism](https://www.boca.gov.tw/fp-158-250-a5a40-2.html)
<https://www.boca.gov.tw/fp-158-250-a5a40-2.html>
12. [Taiwan BOCA - eVisa eligibility](https://visawebapp.boca.gov.tw/BOCA_EVISA/MRV04FORM)
https://visawebapp.boca.gov.tw/BOCA_EVISA/MRV04FORM
13. [KKday - northeast coast Plan A-C](https://www.kkday.com/en/product/2287-jiufen-yehliu-shifen-pingxi-day-tour-night-tour-from-taipei)
<https://www.kkday.com/en/product/2287-jiufen-yehliu-shifen-pingxi-day-tour-night-tour-from-taipei>
14. [Klook - northeast coast tour](https://www.klook.com/activity/76306-yehliu-jiufen-shifen-golden-waterfall-day-tour/)
<https://www.klook.com/activity/76306-yehliu-jiufen-shifen-golden-waterfall-day-tour/>
15. [Klook - Yangmingshan and Beitou tour](https://www.klook.com/en-US/activity/150857-yangmingsan-beitou-day-tour/)
<https://www.klook.com/en-US/activity/150857-yangmingsan-beitou-day-tour/>
16. [Official Okinawa guide - Ishigaki Island](https://visitokinawajapan.com/destinations/yaeyama-islands/ishigaki-island/)
<https://visitokinawajapan.com/destinations/yaeyama-islands/ishigaki-island/>
17. [Yaima Line - Keelung-Ishigaki ferry](https://www.yaimaline.com/en/)
<https://www.yaimaline.com/en/>
18. [Official Okinawa ferry information](https://www.kotsu-okinawa.org/en/index_ferry.html)
https://www.kotsu-okinawa.org/en/index_ferry.html
19. [Japan MOFA - eVisa sea-entry limitations](https://www.mofa.go.jp/j_info/visit/visa/visaonline.html)
https://www.mofa.go.jp/j_info/visit/visa/visaonline.html
20. [Example current 14-day Taiwan route](https://www.taiwananswered.com/taiwan-14-day-itinerary/)
<https://www.taiwananswered.com/taiwan-14-day-itinerary/>
21. [Example two-week Taiwan loop](https://www.willflyforfood.net/two-weeks-in-taiwan-a-14-day-itinerary-exploring-the-best-of-taiwan/)
<https://www.willflyforfood.net/two-weeks-in-taiwan-a-14-day-itinerary-exploring-the-best-of-taiwan/>

Document scope

This is a planning document, not a booking confirmation. It reflects publicly available information checked in September 2026. Prices, operations, visa decisions, weather and attraction access remain subject to the relevant provider or authority.